MBAI 5410: Digital Transformation

Transforming Data into Decisions

A Unified Analytics Strategy for [Company Name] Group

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Executive Summary

[Company Name] Group, an 80-year-old Canadian real estate development firm, has experienced continued growth. These expansions over the past eight decades have increased operational complexity. Across [Company Name]'s residential, commercial, and land development business units, this complexity is primarily driven by fragmented data systems, reliance on manual workflows, and inconsistent reporting practices. These challenges have led to delayed decision-making, heightened operational risk, and limitations in the organization's ability to scale efficiently. As the demand for real-time, data-driven insights continues to rise, the current state is no longer sustainable.

To address these issues, this report recommends implementing Microsoft Fabric as a unified, enterprise-wide analytics platform. This transformation will centralize data, automate reporting processes, and enable real-time, data-driven decision-making across the organization. The expected impact includes a 50% reduction in reporting time, near elimination of manual reporting errors, measurable cost savings through system consolidation, and improved organizational agility. In addition to operational improvements, this initiative establishes a scalable data foundation capable of supporting future capabilities in automation, advanced analytics, and artificial intelligence.

While the benefits are significant, the transformation introduces several risks, including data quality challenges, potential resistance to adoption, integration complexity, and long-term vendor dependency. These risks will be mitigated through a phased implementation strategy, strong governance supported by Microsoft Purview, and a structured change management approach.

This transformation positions [Company Name] Group to transition from fragmented, reactive decision-making to a centralized, real-time, insight-driven operating model that supports scalable growth and long-term competitive advantage; ultimately, building a sustainable foundation for future digital innovation and enabling [Company Name] to make faster and more informed strategic decisions. Microsoft Fabric will consolidate [Company Name]'s fragmented data environment into a single unified analytics platform, delivering measurable ROI within 18 months.

Strategic Context & Decision Rationale

[Company Name] Group's current operational challenges stem from the natural evolution of its systems and processes over time, which developed in isolation as the organization expanded. Like many growing firms, [Company Name] scaled its operations without simultaneously modernizing its underlying systems and decision-making structures. This has led to significant data silos, duplicated efforts, and a heavy reliance on manual and paper-based workflows. As a result, decision-making is often based on incomplete or outdated information, contributing to inefficiencies, delayed responses, and increased exposure to operational and compliance risks.

At the process level, inefficiencies are driven by decentralized workflows, informal approval structures, and reliance on outsourced or manual processes, which limit consistency and scalability. From a systems perspective, the lack of platform integration restricts data flow and prevents the organization from generating timely, reliable insights. Additionally, knowledge dependency presents a critical structural risk, as key processes are often understood only by specific individuals, with no centralized knowledge base to support continuity. This creates vulnerability in the event of employee turnover and limits organizational learning. Cultural factors also play a role, as resistance to change, limited employee capacity to support transformation, and conservative leadership attitudes toward technological investment slow the pace of modernization.

To address these challenges, it is necessary to establish a more structured, integrated approach to how information flows across the organization and how decisions are made at both the operational and strategic levels. Creating a cohesive data and decision architecture enables [Company Name] to improve cross-functional coordination and operate more competitively alongside organizations that have already embraced digital transformation, enhancing efficiency and scalability.

To guide the selection of an appropriate transformation initiative, a structured Multi-Criteria Decision Analysis (MCDA) framework was then applied to evaluate three potential transformation opportunities: land acquisition digitization, timesheet enhancement, and streamlined reporting. Clear evaluation criteria were established, focusing on strategic value, operational efficiency, risk reduction, scalability, implementation difficulty, and cultural readiness. These criteria ensured that any proposed solution would align with long-term business objectives while remaining realistic in terms of execution. Strategic value was prioritized (30%) to ensure that the selected transformation directly addresses [Company Name]'s core challenge of fragmented decision-making and supports long-term market competitiveness. Operational efficiency (20%) reflects the need to reduce manual workflows and improve processing speed. Risk reduction (10%) aligns with the organization's exposure to data inaccuracies and knowledge dependencies. Implementation difficulty (15%) was included to ensure the solution is feasible given the current climate at [Company Name] and resourcing constraints. Scalability (10%) was critical to identify if the solution could support [Company Name]'s continued growth. Finally, cultural readiness (15%) reflected the importance of adopting the digital transformation, given the culture and resistance to change.

Each option was assessed through the lens of key uncertainties and trade-offs. In the case of land acquisition, uncertainties centred on whether increased structure would reduce flexibility and whether critical knowledge held by experts could be effectively transferred. The trade-offs involved balancing standardization and flexibility, preserving individual expertise, and improving organizational resilience. For timesheet enhancement, uncertainties centred on employee adoption and leadership enforcement, while trade-offs weighed short-term disruption against long-term efficiency and the choice between off-the-shelf and customized solutions. Streamlined reporting highlighted uncertainties about user adoption across management levels and data access controls, as well as trade-offs among ease of access, data security, and transparency versus control.

Across all options, the evaluation emphasized solutions that would enhance organizational resilience, support learning, improve data accuracy, and enable better decision-making without introducing excessive complexity or risk. The MCDA results identified streamlined reporting as the strongest option, achieving the highest overall score due to its ability to deliver meaningful impact across all evaluation criteria.

The results of the MCDA are summarized below:

Criteria	**Weights**	**Land Acquisition**	**Timesheet Enhancement**	**Streamlined Reporting**
Strategic Value	30%	3	4	4
Operational Efficiency	20%	4	4	3
Risk Reduction	10%	4	2	5
Implementation Difficulty	15%	5	3	5
Scalability	10%	5	5	5
Cultural Readiness	15%	1	1	1
Total Score	**100%**	**3.5**	**2.9**	**3.8**

This outcome reflects that reporting inefficiencies constitute a core operational bottleneck within [Company Name]. The current reliance on manual data consolidation slows decision-making and reduces confidence in insights. By contrast, a streamlined reporting solution addresses the root cause of these challenges by unifying data sources, improving accessibility, and enabling real-time, reliable insights. This not only enhances decision quality and speed but also establishes enterprise-wide data governance and creates a scalable foundation for future digital initiatives.

The strength of this recommendation is in its combination of the MCDA criteria and [Company Name]'s operational realities. Overall, it is feasible to implement, scalable, able to overcome any cultural and structural barriers and most importantly, will have a large impact on the operational and strategic goals of [Company Name].

Based on this analysis, [Company Name] should prioritize streamlined reporting, as it addresses immediate operational inefficiencies and lays the foundation for more advanced capabilities, including automation, predictive analytics, and artificial intelligence, in future phases.

Vendor & Solution Justification

Market Options Considered

Our procurement evaluation considered four platforms: Fabric, Databricks, AWS, and SAP, all of which offered tools and solutions suitable for [Company Name]'s data reporting needs. Each platform was assessed on its ability to address core organizational challenges, including data silos, limited integration, weak governance, and inefficient reporting processes.

- Microsoft Fabric: A unified SaaS solution that integrates data engineering, warehousing, and BI.
- Databricks: a data platform focused on advanced data engineering, analytics, and machine learning.
- Amazon Web Services (AWS): a cloud ecosystem offering a wide range of scalable data storage, processing and analytical services.
- Crystal Reports (SAP): A traditional reporting tool used for structured report generation within legacy enterprise environments.

The evaluation criteria were designed to reflect both strategic priorities and operational realities. These included ecosystem integration, data governance and security, scalability, ease of use and adoption, vendor stability, and total cost of ownership. A higher weight (35%) was assigned to ecosystem integration to reflect [Company Name]'s current technical landscape and reliance on Microsoft 365. This ensured that the selected solution would not only meet technical requirements but also align with [Company Name]’s existing infrastructure, workforce capabilities, and long-term growth objectives.

Comparative Evaluation

Criteria	Weight (%)	Fabric	Databricks	AWS	SAP
Ecosystem & Data Integration	35	5	4	4	2
Enterprise Security & Governance	20	5	4	5	3
Ease of Use & Adoption	15	4	3	3.5	4
Platform Scalability	15	5	5	5	3
Stability & Support	10	5	4	5	5
Economic Value	5	4	3	3.5	5
Weighted total	**100**	**4.8**	**3.95**	**4.35**	**3.1**

From a market perspective, each platform presented distinct strengths and limitations. Databricks demonstrated strong capabilities in advanced data engineering and data science; however, it introduces a high level of technical complexity that exceeds [Company Name]’s current internal capabilities, increasing reliance on specialized resources. AWS offers robust scalability and flexibility but requires significant manual configuration and “glue code” to integrate dissimilar services, making implementation more resource-intensive and less aligned with [Company Name]’s existing Microsoft ecosystem. Crystal Reports (SAP), while familiar to some users, is a legacy solution with limited scalability and no clear pathway to modern analytics capabilities, such as real-time insights or AI integration.

In contrast, Microsoft Fabric emerged as the most balanced and strategically aligned solution. Its strength lies in its ability to unify data engineering, warehousing, and business intelligence within a single SaaS platform, reducing the need for multiple disconnected tools. Microsoft Fabric delivers a unified experience that gives it a clear advantage over platforms like Databricks, AWS, and Crystal Reports by eliminating the friction in fragmented data architectures.

While AWS typically requires piecing together various services for storage and analytics, Fabric is an all-in-one ecosystem that uses a single resource pool for all workloads. This significantly reduces administrative overhead and "technical debt." Unlike Databricks, which may still require physical data movement for analytics, Fabric uses OneLake shortcuts and Direct Lake mode to enable real-time reporting on a single data copy, getting quicker insights. While traditional tools like SAP's Crystal Reports can lead to data silos, Fabric standardizes on the Delta Lake format, removing data duplication and integrating intelligence directly into Microsoft 365 workflows such as Teams and Excel.

Compared to alternatives, Fabric demonstrated superior ecosystem integration, particularly through its native compatibility with Microsoft 365 and existing enterprise systems, which significantly lowers implementation friction and accelerates adoption. It also provides strong data governance through built-in Microsoft Purview capabilities, ensuring that security, compliance, and data management are embedded from the outset rather than retrofitted at a later stage.

A key differentiator for Microsoft Fabric is its architectural approach to data management. Through OneLake shortcuts and data virtualization, Fabric enables the organization to access and analyze data across multiple sources without requiring extensive physical data migration. This reduces duplication, shortens time-to-insight, and minimizes the risks typically associated with large-scale data movement. Additionally, the platform's unified capacity model consolidates all workloads into a single resource pool, simplifying both operational management and financial planning.

Despite these advantages, several trade-offs were carefully considered. Microsoft Fabric is not a rapid, plug-and-play solution and requires a disciplined, phased implementation supported by strong change management practices. It also introduces a degree of vendor dependency due to its deep integration within the Microsoft ecosystem. However, these trade-offs are outweighed by the platform's ability to address the root causes of [Company Name]'s challenges rather than offering incremental improvements.

From a financial perspective, Microsoft Fabric provides a compelling value proposition through its consumption-based pricing model, which aligns costs with actual usage and eliminates the inefficiencies associated with over-provisioned infrastructure. Microsoft Fabric's capacity-based pricing (F SKU model) starts at approximately CAD $350–500/month for entry-level F2 capacity, estimated to consolidate [Company Name]'s fragmented tool spend while enabling a pay-as-you-scale model. By consolidating multiple legacy tools and licenses- such as standalone reporting systems and fragmented analytics solutions- into a single platform, [Company Name] can reduce overall licensing costs and transition toward a more predictable operating expense model. Furthermore, the reduction in manual data processing and reporting effort represents a significant source of hidden return on investment, as it frees up employee capacity for higher-value activities and improves overall productivity.

Ultimately, Microsoft Fabric achieved the highest composite evaluation score due to its ability to balance performance across all critical dimensions, including integration, governance, usability, scalability, and cost efficiency. Its selection is justified not only by its technical capabilities but also by its alignment with [Company Name]'s organizational context, making it the most effective solution for enabling a unified, scalable, and future-ready analytics environment.

Microsoft Fabric wins over the other vendors due to its high scores across the board, with notably high scores in Ecosystem & Data Integration (35%) and Enterprise Security and Governance (20%), which account for over half of the weighted total score. This is largely due to the fact that it integrates so well into [Company Name]'s current technical landscape, which is highly driven by Microsoft 365 and Microsoft Purview to provide role-based security and data governance easily.

Final Justification

Microsoft Fabric is the best overall fit given [Company Name]'s needs. It simplifies the current data structure by bringing everything onto a single platform to create a single source of truth, thereby supporting better decision-making. Compared to the other options, Fabric is the clear winner due to its implementation feasibility and seamless integration with existing systems. In addition, it is a highly scalable cloud-based architecture to support [Company Name]'s strategic growth. While it requires careful implementation and ongoing governance, it offers the best balance between operational usability and strategic long-term value.

As a result, Microsoft Fabric is the most effective choice to support a unified, scalable and sustainable data strategy for [Company Name].

Implementation & Change Execution Plan

Overview of Phased Project Plan:

The implementation of Microsoft Fabric will follow a phased approach designed to minimize operational disruption and ensure adoption. The 5 phases are outlined below, along with the key milestones and any dependencies, to ensure a successful implementation and manage risk.

Phase	Key Milestones	Dependencies

Phase 1 Planning and Analysis (Month 1)	● Requirements documentation completed ● Data source inventory completed ● Feasibility analysis completed ● Technical architecture and governance defined ● Training plan defined	● IT team collaboration ● Access to internal systems ● Stakeholder input
Phase 2 System Design & Development (Months 2 & 3)	● Data architecture finalized ● Data pipelines built ● Role-based security designed ● Initial canned reports/dashboards created ● Develop training materials and knowledge base	● Completed requirements ● Technical configuration of Microsoft Fabric ● Vendor support
Phase 3 Integration & Testing (Month 4)	● Successful system integration ● Data migration and validation ● Pilot implementation with the Accounting Department to validate data accuracy, reporting functionality and user experience ● User acceptance testing (UAT) is completed	● Stable data pipelines ● Successful and accurate data migration ● User support/ participation in testing
Phase	**Key Milestones**	**Dependencies**
Phase 4 Deployment & Organizational Rollout (Months 5 & 6)	● Access and security controls are configured ● Platform deployed organization-wide ● Initial canned reports and dashboards are made available ● User training completed	● Successful testing ● Users are ready to train ● Security approval
Phase 5 Optimization & Continuous Improvement (Ongoing)	● System performance improved ● Analytics features expanded ● User adoption increased	● Users Feedback/Input ● Phase 4 KPI baseline Review ● Executive Sign-Off

Integration & Technical Approach

Priority is to integrate Microsoft Fabric with the existing Microsoft 365 workflows and ecosystem to deliver seamless data flow across business units. Data will be migrated to OneLake using a phased approach with Direct Lake Shortcuts, enabling a single source of truth and drastically reducing errors and time spent on data preparation. To ensure a successful implementation, a pilot will be completed with the Accounting department before implementing organization-wide to ensure it meets specific business requirements. The vendor will be involved throughout the life of the system, leveraging them for implementation and ongoing updates as required. This implementation is estimated to require a dedicated 4–6-person cross-functional team for the first 6 months. Implementation will require an internal project lead, Microsoft Certified partner support, and a dedicated change manager.

Training & Adoption Strategy

The strategy below will ensure users can effectively use the system and drive adoption of the new technology across the organization, resulting in a smooth, easy transition to Microsoft Fabric.

The key stakeholders that should be considered in this rollout are:

1. Finance and Accounting: Primary users of automated reporting
2. Commercial, Residential, and Land development teams: Users of operational dashboards and insights
3. Business Solutions: System implementation and management
4. Corporate Records: Data governance and compliance
5. HR: Training coordination
6. Executive Team: Strategic decision-making

The training approach includes:

- Super users in various teams to help provide peer-to-peer support
- Hands-on workshops
- E-learning modules and quick guides that users can access on demand.

In addition, continuous support will be provided through a help desk and feedback loops to address issues and improve adoption.

A strong communication strategy will help ensure change management is adequately addressed by providing regular company-wide updates throughout the implementation process, explaining the reason for the change and how it will affect employees. The recommendation is weekly updates from leadership on implementation status and project progress via emails and presentations, as well as a feedback mechanism to receive ongoing feedback from staff on project implementation and address any issues as they arise, and department champions (Power Users) will be identified within each business unit to drive grassroots adoption.

Governance Structure

Governance is critical when implementing a centralized reporting platform. By leveraging Microsoft Purview, governance can be centralized and easily controlled. This involves implementing role-based access controls to protect sensitive information and prevent unauthorized data exposures, defining clear data ownership and providing ongoing monitoring. Compliance with internal policies and regulatory standards will be maintained through regular auditing and oversight.

Risk and Mitigation Overview

This Risk and Mitigation Overview identifies the primary challenges that could impact the project's timeline, data integrity, and user acceptance. By proactively categorizing risks- ranging from technical integration to organizational adoption- we established a robust framework to safeguard the project's success.

Risk Description	**Likelihood**	**Impact**	**Mitigation Strategy**
Scope Creep	Medium	High	• Clearly define what is IN scope and what is OUT of scope • Strict adherence to IN Scope requirements • Move all new requests to another project phase
Delayed migration due to poor data quality	Medium	High	• Data analysis • Clean and transform data • Pre-migration data validation
Low user adoption	Medium	High	• Training programs for running/creating reports and using dashboards • Implementation of a parallel system approach • Report verification (cross-system verification)
System Integration failures (**all** data sources)	Low	High	• Early vendor engagement with IT • Gather all smaller data stores and centralize for ingestion
Internal Data Breach & Governance during rollout	Low	High	• Examine current access controls across systems and files • Audit of access controls of the implemented system • Create and enforce policies for access control
Delay in vendor support	Low	Medium	• Project roadmap with milestones • Active communication with the vendor

Success Metrics

To ensure that success is measurable post-implementation, we will utilize the following metrics:

- Active Users on platform (>75% within 5 months)
- Training completion rate (100% within 5 months)

- Data error rate (Near 0% in 6 months)
- Decline in support requests over time (50% decline within 6 months)

Globally Sustainable Digital Transformation

The Microsoft Fabric implementation advances [Company Name] Group's commitment to responsible digital transformation across environmental, social, and governance dimensions. This transformation aligns with the principles of sustainable and responsible digital innovation by promoting more efficient use of data and technology resources. By reducing redundant systems and streamlining data processes, the organization can lower its overall energy consumption while improving operational efficiency. This is consistent with United Nations Sustainable Development Goal 9 (SDG 9), which aims to "Build resilient infrastructure, promote inclusive and sustainable industrialization and foster innovation."

The implementation also supports greater inclusivity within the organization by ensuring equal access to data, enabling employees at all levels to engage with insights and make informed decisions. However, there is some risk that differences in employees' technical abilities and digital literacy may lead to unequal adoption across teams. To address this, training and ongoing support are essential to ensure the benefits of this transformation are evenly distributed.

Strong governance frameworks are essential to ensure ethical data use, transparency, and compliance with regulatory requirements. This includes clearly defined data ownership, role-based access controls and audit and oversight mechanisms to prevent the misuse of information and protect privacy. Post-implementation, as [Company Name] moves towards advanced analytics and artificial intelligence in reporting, risks related to data biases, misinterpreted insights, and over-reliance on automated decision-making should be monitored. It is essential to have human oversight, even with automation, to help mitigate these emerging risks.

By migrating to Microsoft Fabric, [Company Name] has significantly decreased its global environmental footprint. This shift involves moving its on-premises servers directly into OneLake, which, over the medium term, lowers the company's energy consumption. Moreover, [Company Name] is embracing sustainable practices by leveraging Microsoft's carbon-neutral data centers in Canada (Canada Central and Canada East), and is committed to being carbon-negative by 2030.

In addition to environmental benefits, the digital transition eliminates paper-based, manual reporting processes, thereby reducing the use of physical resources. Furthermore, to address the sensitive nature of [Company Name]'s property data, tenancy information, and financial records, Microsoft is actively collaborating with Canadian regions to ensure compliance with critical data residency requirements.

It is important to recognize that achieving these outcomes requires more than technology alone. Organizational readiness, cultural alignment, and ongoing investment in training are essential to bridging the gap between expected benefits and realized outcomes. Over the long term, this transformation enhances organizational resilience and supports sustainable growth in an increasingly data-driven environment. The Microsoft Fabric implementation advances [Company Name] Group's commitment to responsible digital transformation across environmental, social, and governance dimensions.

Expected Impact & Performance Monitoring

The implementation of a unified analytics platform will deliver significant operational, financial, and strategic benefits. Reporting processes will become substantially faster, manual errors will be minimized, and collaboration across business units will improve. These efficiencies will translate into cost savings through reduced manual effort, consolidated systems, and optimized resource utilization.

Strategically, the organization will benefit from faster and more accurate decision-making, improved competitive positioning, and a scalable foundation for future innovation in areas such as artificial intelligence and predictive analytics. Performance will be measured using key indicators, including reporting cycle time, user adoption rates, data accuracy, cost savings, and overall decision-making efficiency.

Evaluation will occur across multiple time horizons, beginning with short-term implementation success and adoption, followed by mid-term efficiency gains and cost improvements, and ultimately long-term strategic impact and competitive advantage.

Evaluation timeline

The following is the proposed evaluation timeline following the post pilot implementation (PPI).

- 30 Days (PPI): Pilot feedback and evaluation, minor adjustment tweaks
- 60 Days (PPI): Resource scaling optimization

- 90 Days (PPI): Adoption analysis with a review of initial KPI assessment
- 6 Months (PPI): Full performance evaluation and business impact assessment

Financial considerations

- Cost savings (in terms of manual hours returned) from manual reporting
- Reduced operational costs by eliminating inefficiencies and rework
- Consolidation of tools reduces licensing and infrastructure costs
- Improved budgeting and forecasting from accurate data
- The pay-as-you-go model helps control costs over time
- ROI expected within 18 months
- An estimated 20–30% reduction in total analytics tool spend

Strategic positioning

The combined operational and strategic impact positions [Company Name] Group to make faster, more confident, data-driven decisions at every level of the organization. This impact can be seen in the following key areas:

- Stronger alignment across departments through shared data
- Improved organizational flexibility and faster response to market changes
- Enhanced competitiveness in a market moving toward AI and automation
- Reduction in strategic risk caused by fragmented systems and silos

Defined KPIs

The following KPIs define how performance, cost, governance, and value will be measured following implementation.

1. *Operational Performance*

KPI	Description	Target	Measurement Method
Report Generation Time	Measures the end-to-end time required to create and deliver business reports	Decrease 50% during the pilot phase	Average time from report request to delivery (start to completion)

Manual Data Processing Effort	Measures reduction in manual data handling activities such as cleaning, merging, and Excel-based processing	Decrease by 40–60% within 3 months	Time spent on manual data preparation tasks
Data Error Rate	Measures the accuracy of reporting outputs and the reduction of inconsistencies	~0% within 6 months	Number of errors / total records processed

2. *Data Integration & Platform Adoption*

KPI	Description	Target	Measurement Method
Data Sources Integrated	Measures the extent of system consolidation into OneLake	100% centralized within 1st month	Integrated sources / total enterprise data sources
Active Users on Platform	Measures the level of user engagement and adoption across the organization	>75% within 5 months	Active users / total licensed users
Self-Service Report Usage	Measures shift toward decentralized, user-driven reporting	>50% of reports are user-generated	User-generated reports / total reports

3. *Financial Performance*

KPI	Description	Target	Measurement Method
Tool Consolidation Savings	Measures cost reduction from replacing legacy tools with Microsoft Fabric	20–30% reduction in total analytics tool spend within 2 months	Old system costs vs. new Fabric cost model

ROI Timeline	Measures overall financial return from implementation	ROI achieved within 18 months	(Total Benefits – Total Costs) / Total Costs
Capacity Utilization Efficiency	Measures the efficiency of cloud resource usage	Optimized capacity usage with minimal waste, Monthly review	Fabric Capacity Metrics App utilization data

4. *Governance, Risk and Adoption*

KPI	**Description**	**Target**	**Measurement Method**
Governance Debt Avoidance	Measures avoided the cost of retroactive data governance remediation	Reduction in post-implementation remediation effort	Comparison of pre/post governance effort
Compliance Risk Mitigation	Measures reduction in regulatory and data exposure risk	Increased coverage of sensitivity labels and DLP policies 100% compliant on critical info (within 3 months)	Percentage of governed data assets
Training Completion Rate	Measures workforce readiness for platform adoption	100% within 5 months	Trained users / total assigned users
Mental Acceptance Level	Measures employee comfort and acceptance of the new platform	Measured by quarterly pulse surveys targeting System Usability Scale (SUS) score ≥ 75	User surveys and feedback scores

5. *Strategic Impact*

KPI	Description	Target	Measurement Method
Data Discovery Speed	Measures the time required to locate trusted, certified data	50 % reduction in "search time." within 3 months	Time-to-find data in the OneLake catalogue
Decision-Making Speed & Quality	Measures improvement in business responsiveness and decision accuracy	Benchmark process Times - min 75% faster decision cycles	Comparative pre/post-decision cycle analysis
Organizational Alignment	Measures the consistency of data usage across departments	100% "single source of truth."	Cross-departmental data usage consistency

Final Recommendation & Next Steps

Based on the analysis, [Company Name] Group should proceed with implementing Microsoft Fabric as its unified analytics platform, beginning immediately with the planning and analysis phase. This recommendation is supported by strong alignment with strategic objectives, clear operational benefits, and the ability to address the root causes of current challenges.

The immediate next steps involve securing executive approval and sponsorship, aligning stakeholders, conducting a detailed data readiness assessment, finalizing governance and architectural design, and establishing a dedicated project team. These actions will ensure a strong foundation for successful implementation.

Next Step	Owner	Timeline
Secure executive approval	CEO / Board	Week 1-2
Conduct a data readiness assessment	IT + Business Solutions	Weeks 2-4
Finalize governance architecture	IT + Corporate Records	Month 1
Establish project team	HR + Business Solutions	Month 1
Engage the Microsoft implementation partner	Procurement	Month 1-2

This transformation represents more than a technology upgrade. It is a fundamental shift toward becoming a data-driven organization. Delaying this transformation risks continued data fragmentation, growing technical debt, and loss of competitive ground to organizations that have already embraced unified analytics. By acting now, [Company Name] Group can enhance its operational efficiency, strengthen its competitive position, and build the capabilities required to thrive in an increasingly complex, data-centric business environment, giving it the edge over its competitors.